

Return to MOONRAIN DEPTHS

by Jocarnail

How to introduce the adventure

The party may have been hired by Allyn Hart directly to help them reach the depths or by a loved one that asked the party to find Allyn and protect them. The adventurers may also have been led to the adventure by promise of riches and magic hidden in the depths.

Who's your Allyn

Fit the character to your need. Young or old. Men, woman, or neither. Any species. If you wish to, use an established character of your world as your Allyn.

Who was Allyn

Allyn was once the leader of those that became the bird-people of moonrain depths. They lost their memory when they completed the ritual by boiling the water of the geyser and were carried away by the moon. During this process they may have gained a new appearance, and even become young.

Beaconed to the Moonrain Depths, follow Allyn Hart in their search for answers on their past that they themselves may not want to find! The Depths call out, and someone has to answer! Diving into the damp underground complex that were once a holy path for grieving souls a daring group of adventurers will clash with the bird-people—once common folks, twisted by the magic of the caves in bestial forms—to gather gold, mysterious trinkets, and questions.

Moonrain Depths is a system of hidden caves that was once a temple dedicated to the moon. It is here where people that were overburdened by grief once traveled in pilgrimage, boiled water near the sacred geyser, and were spirited away by the moon, to be rid of their memories and sometimes to start a new life altogether.

Many moons past Allyn too visited Moonrain Depths—although they are not aware of this. As the leader of their people, they guided them in the depths; and when Allyn was carried away by the Moon, their followers were twisted into the bird-people that still inhabits the Depths, guarding their own prison.

1. The Moonrock

A boulder in the wilderness that marks the entrance of the depths. The entrance is hidden; on the top of the rock is a flat spot with runes carved:

When tears wet this sacred stone follow their melancholy into the depths. When they met the stream of sadness they will guide you toward life anew.

Water that flows down from the top of the rock leads to an hidden crevice in the stones at the base of the moonrock, into a narrow tunnel and toward the depths.

2. The river of tears

A underground stream; shallow and with rounded gravel as its bed. Leads to a waterfall that drops deep into ancient ruins.

Below the waterfall there is a slightly hidden passage made out of broken tiles.

3. Ablution room

A small square room with a pool at the center. The water fills the pool from a bass-relief carved in the northern wall—an iconography of a crying moon—and drains out through a shallow channel toward the river. Half hidden at the bottom of the pool is a small golden key.

4. Temple lobby

A simple room built into the rock. The ancient bass-reliefs are too damaged to be recognized.

Here is the first bird-person. A scout waiting in ambush.

5. Prayer room

A long nave once filled with benches. It was used by the pilgrim both as a room for prayer and as temporary lodging. There are several bird-people here.

The waterfall can be seen behind a grate on the wall.

While the benches are long gone, there may still be something useful under the clutter in the corners.

A gilded gate preclude the way further down the temple. It is opened by the small golden key.

6. Waterfall contemplation room

A simple room with rounded corners. A bird-person with two beasts similar to dogs contemplate the waterfall from behind a window. A small hole in the floor drops water to a deeper room. In this room too is a gilded gate.

7. Bird-people camp

Tattered tents and several bird-people armed with picks and shovels. They dug a path through the floor to circumvent the gilded gates they couldn't open.

8. The final confrontation

In a large room with a pool to the south-east waits a final encounter. Choose either a big water elemental creature with some smaller brethren or a congregation of bird-people praying at the back of the room. Fit the encounter to your party and the resources they spent.

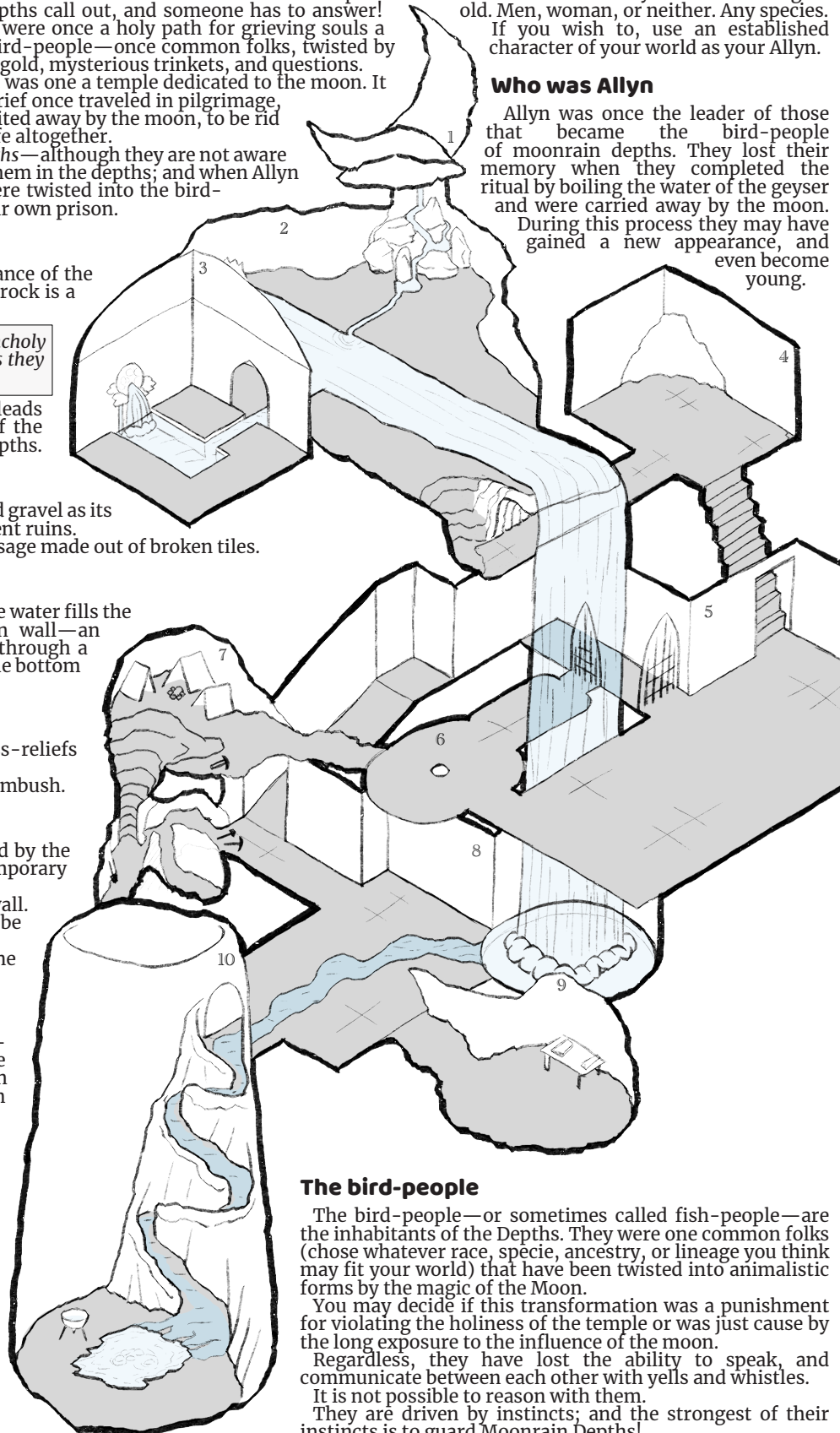
9. Allyn room

Allyn old research room. Once filled with grandiose machinery, most is corroded and useless. Allyn used to be an accomplished alchemist, mage, or spiritual leader in their previous time. Allyn's notes should give many of the answers that the party is seeking.

10. The geyser

The destination is a hollow tower with a geyser at the center. Water flowing from the stream, gathering from the rain on the moonrock fills a boiling pool and periodically explode in a steaming column. Here is also the metal vessel used by Allyn in the ritual.

You reached the end. By this time the party should have most answers. It's up to them to decide what to do with the questions left behind.



The bird-people

The bird-people—or sometimes called fish-people—are the inhabitants of the Depths. They were one common folks (chose whatever race, specie, ancestry, or lineage you think may fit your world) that have been twisted into animalistic forms by the magic of the Moon.

You may decide if this transformation was a punishment for violating the holiness of the temple or was just cause by the long exposure to the influence of the moon.

Regardless, they have lost the ability to speak, and communicate between each other with yells and whistles.

It is not possible to reason with them.

They are driven by instincts; and the strongest of their instincts is to guard Moonrain Depths!